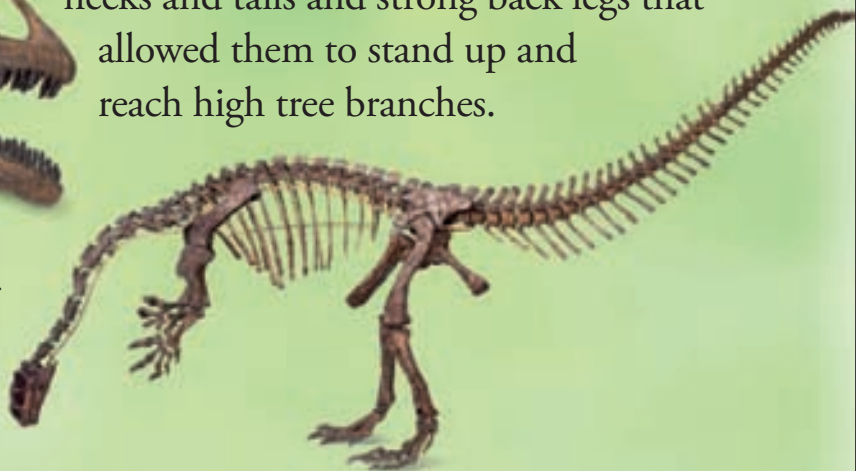


Prosauropods

At the start of the Triassic Period, all dinosaurs were small and stood low on the ground. Over time, a group of mainly plant-eating dinosaurs called the prosauropods grew taller and heavier than their competitors. They evolved long necks and tails and strong back legs that allowed them to stand up and reach high tree branches.



▲ **SCISSOR JAWS**
Sharp teeth could slice through tough leaf stems.



Plateosaurus

PLATE-ee-oh-SORE-us



- **When** 220–210 million years ago (Late Triassic)
- **Fossil location** Germany, Switzerland, Norway, Greenland
- **Habitat** Plains of western Europe
- **Length** 25 ft (8 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Plateosaurus was one of the largest of the prosauropods. It walked on its hind legs, mainly feeding on plants at ground level. It could also stand like a kangaroo, rearing up on its hindlimbs and stretching its long neck to eat leaves from trees. More than 50 complete skeletons of *Plateosaurus* have been found.



FAMILY FACT FILE

Key features

- Small heads
- Long, flexible necks
- Very long thumb claws
- Hindlimbs longer than forelimbs

When

Prosauropods first appeared in the Late Triassic, 217 million years ago. They died out in the Middle Jurassic, 184 million years ago.

Long, curved thumb claw was used for defense and for grasping tree branches.